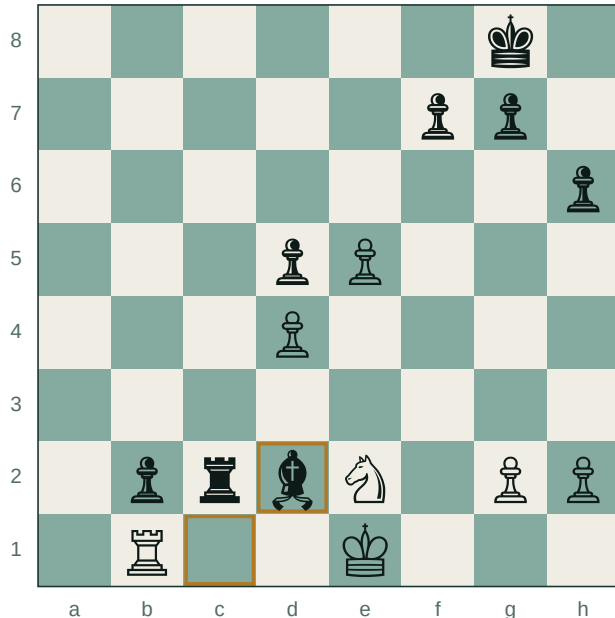


Active defensive resources: White, move 39

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 38...Bd2+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

39. Kd1 Rc1+ 40. Nxc1 bxc1=Q+ 41. Rxc1

39.Kd1 The king moves from e1 to d1. From d1 it attacks rook on c2 and bishop on d2. Recorded reply: **39...Rc1+**.

40.Nxc1 The knight captures the rook on c1. Recorded reply: **40...bxc1=Q+**.

41.Rxc1 The rook captures the queen on c1.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on c2. Check for tactical protection.